

iPod 80 GB

We're Seeing Bigger Apples!

The new iPod throws in an ultra-roomy 80 GB hard disk. Apple hasn't changed the look of the new model, but the display is slightly brighter, making it more legible outdoors. The bundle includes a USB connector-and-charger, a slick suede protective case, and tiny, comfortable ear-bud type phones.

Sound quality is good, but the bundled ear-buds lack punch—other headphones gave better results. The new iPod also makes for a great photo viewer, but the lack of zoom, pan, and rotate abilities is sorely missed. Video playback is quite smooth, and movies look great as always.



Battery life is excellent—we got 18 hours of MP3 playback on a full charge. Video playback drains the juice quicker, and you'll be cut down in a little less than six hours.

Specifications

Fifth-generation; 80 GB; 2.5 inch display (320 x 240); multiple audio and picture format

Contact: Apple Computer International
Phone: 09886039424
E-mail: avinash_ramchandra@asia.apple.com
Web site: www.asia.apple.com
Price: Rs 23,900

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

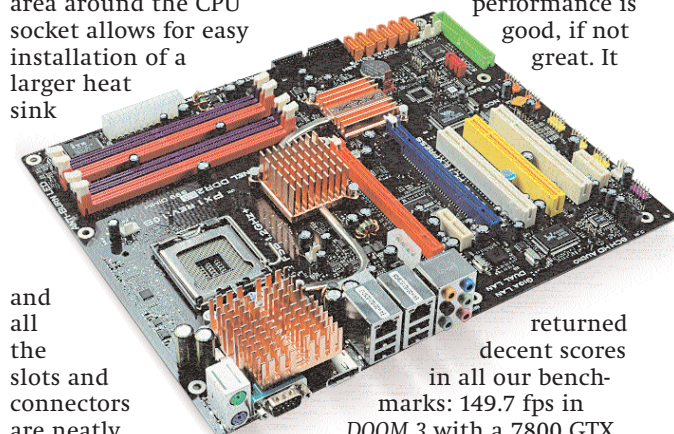
ECS PX1 Extreme

Not Really Extreme...

The ECS PX1 Extreme is one of the earlier Intel P965 chipset based motherboards that support ATI's CrossFire by means of two PCI-E x16 slots. The board has a spacious layout: the area around the CPU socket allows for easy installation of a larger heat sink

Up to 8 GB of DDR2 RAM @ 800 MHz is supported. Its ICH8DH Southbridge is compatible with Intel Viiv, and there's 8-channel HD audio.

This board's performance is good, if not great. It



and all the slots and connectors are neatly laid-out.

returned decent scores in all our benchmarks: 149.7 fps in DOOM 3 with a 7800 GTX, and it encoded a 100 MB

Samsung NV10

Brilliant!

The NV10 defines Samsung's grand re-entry into the digital camera business with class. Gone are the old plastic body, dash of chrome, and the cheap-camera feel; the NV10 exudes reverberating style.

Ergonomics are near-perfect—the placement of the buttons, mode dial, and lens is spot on. The shallow grip means a perfect and secure fit in one's palm. The large 2.5-inch LCD adorns the back, with a host of touch-sensitive buttons lined on the sides. The screen is large enough to be used in direct sunlight. With the NV10 comes a completely different menu interface that's superb and intuitive once you get the hang of it. The interface is driven by the touch sensitive buttons.

The NV10 cramps a 10-megapixel sensor into that sleek black body. The lens is a standard 3X optical assortment from Schneider-Kreuznach. The flash is neatly tucked away, and pops up automatically when required. In our tests, the NV10 delivered good photographs; outdoor performance using the Auto setting is brilliant. However, the colour rendition is overwhelming—there's too much saturation, though this can be fixed in Photoshop. Apart from Auto, there are a lot of



modes to choose from; one such is ASR for image stabilisation. There's also a manual mode, of course.

At Rs 24,990, the NV10 is priced on the higher side. But price aside, we really appreciate the new user interface, and the only problem we have is the over-saturation. Considering that the NV10 is the third camera in the series, we expect to see even better models.

Specifications

10 megapixel; 3X optical zoom; 19 MB internal memory; SD/MMC card; Image stabilisation mode; 2.5-inch screen; six White Balance presets; 11 Scene Modes; three Metering Modes; rechargeable battery

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Contact: Samsung Electronics India Ltd
Phone: 011-4151 1234
E-mail: rajiv.k@samsung.com
Price: Rs 24,990

Specifications

Intel P965 chipset; support for a Core 2 Duo CPU; dual-Gigabit LAN; E-SATA port; 8-channel audio; upto 10 USB 2.0 and 2 IEEE 1394a; 7 SATA; ICH8DH Southbridge; 2 PCI-E x16 slots

VOB file in 76 seconds with a Core 2 Duo X6800. The motherboard is certainly good for those who want to build an entertainment PC, but not for hard-core gamers or enthusiasts.

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Contact: Mediatech India Distribution Pvt Ltd
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Web site: www.ecs.com.tw
Price: Rs 7,935